01-25 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） The Long Story of Chinese Characters

① Chinese characters are among the oldest writing systems in the world that are still used today. Unlike English letters, most characters began as small pictures. Thousands of years ago, people in ancient China drew simple shapes of things they saw every day. These shapes slowly turned into the characters we read now.

② The earliest Chinese writing we know is on animal bones and turtle shells. It is called "Oracle Bone Script." People used fire to heat the bones until they cracked, and then they wrote questions and answers on them. Some of these characters are not very different from today's writing. For example, the character for "sun" looked like a round shape with a small dot inside, which is still true for the modern 日.

③ As time went by, the tools for writing changed. From bones to bronze, from bronze to bamboo strips, and later to soft paper, each change pushed characters to become easier to write. The curves became cleaner, and new styles, such as the neat "regular script," appeared. Calligraphy, the art of writing beautifully with a brush, became an important part of Chinese culture.

④ Chinese characters are also interesting because many of them join two or three simple parts. The word "好" (good) is made of a "woman" part and a "child" part — a mother with a child is a happy thing. The word "森" (forest) has three trees. Just by looking at the parts, we can often guess the meaning.

⑤ Today, most students type characters on computers and phones, and some people worry that young people may forget how to write by hand. Many schools now hold calligraphy classes so that children can feel the beauty of brushes and ink. Learning characters is not only about passing exams. Each character is a small window into the past — a past that is still living in our daily words.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What did most ancient Chinese characters begin as?

A. Musical notes.
B. Simple pictures of everyday things.
C. Numbers and calculations.
D. Lines of poetry.

2. What is "Oracle Bone Script"?

A. A new style of modern Chinese.
B. Writing on animal bones and turtle shells.
C. A kind of English writing used in Europe.
D. A group of songs sung in temples.

3. Which of the following did NOT appear in the long development of Chinese writing?

A. Bones.
B. Bronze.
C. Bamboo strips.
D. Plastic cards.

4. Why does the character "好" (good) have a "woman" and a "child" part?

A. Because only women can write characters.
B. Because a mother with a child shows something happy.
C. Because children are good at drawing.
D. Because women always teach calligraphy.

5. What is the writer's main idea in the last paragraph?

A. Computers will completely replace Chinese characters soon.
B. Typing on phones is better than writing by hand.
C. Each character is a window into a still-living past.
D. Only young children should learn calligraphy.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "most characters began as small pictures."
【解析】最早多为简单图画。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "writing we know is on animal bones and turtle shells. It is called 'Oracle Bone Script.'"
【解析】甲骨文是刻在动物骨头与龟甲上的文字。A、C、D 均不符。故选 B。

3.
【答案】D

【题型】细节理解题（排除型）
【定位】第③段 "From bones to bronze, from bronze to bamboo strips, and later to soft paper..."
【解析】只提到骨头、青铜、竹简、纸张，未提"塑料卡"。故选 D。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】词义/细节题
【定位】第④段 "a mother with a child is a happy thing."
【解析】母子在一起代表美好。A、C、D 均非原文含义。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】末段 "Each character is a small window into the past — a past that is still living in our daily words."
【解析】作者强调每个汉字都是通向过去的窗户。A、B、D 均偏离或与原文相反。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **oracle** [n.] 神谕（此处为"甲骨"）
- **bronze** [n.] 青铜
- **script** [n.] 字体；文字